

Digital Forensics Case Study

Windows 7 Hard Drive Forensic Investigation

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Project Overview

This project involved conducting a forensic examination of a Windows 7 hard drive image using Autopsy. The objective was to identify user activity, recover digital artifacts, analyze browser history, and determine whether evidence of suspicious or criminal activity existed on the system.

Tools and Technologies

- Autopsy Digital Forensics Platform
- Windows 7 Forensic Artifacts Analysis
- Browser History and Internet Artifact Examination
- Deleted File Recovery and Analysis

Methodology

The investigation began by identifying the operating system, user account information, and system configuration. The hard drive image was loaded into Autopsy, where user artifacts, browser history, deleted files, and index.dat records were examined. Keyword searches were conducted to identify relevant evidence, and recovered files were analyzed to establish a timeline of user activity.

Key Findings

The examination revealed evidence of surveillance-related activity involving financial institutions, including stored and deleted photographs of banks. Browser artifacts contained searches related to robbery penalties, robbery classifications, body armor, untraceable firearms, false identification documents, travel routes, and cross-border travel planning. Multiple sources of evidence were correlated to reconstructing user behavior and identify patterns of potentially suspicious activity.

Skills Demonstrated

- Digital Forensics Investigation
- Evidence Collection and Preservation
- Disk Image Analysis
- Artifact Recovery and Examination
- Browser History Analysis
- Investigative Reasoning
- Technical Documentation and Reporting
- Chain of Custody Awareness

Professional Reflection

This project strengthened my ability to conduct structured forensic investigations and communicate findings through professional reporting. It also provided practical experience using industry-standard forensic tools to analyze digital evidence, recover artifacts, and develop evidence-based conclusions.

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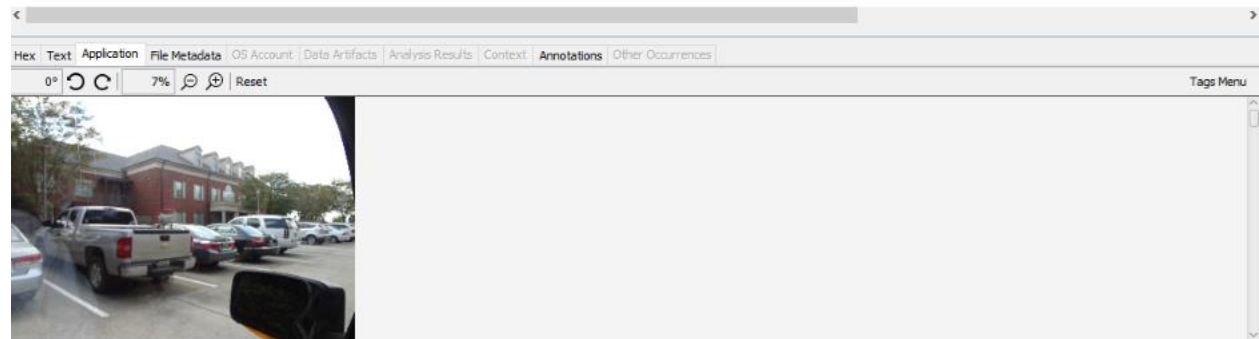
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Hex	Text	Application	Source File Metadata	OS Account	Data Artifacts	Analysis Results	Context	Annotations	Other Occurrences
Result: 1 of 1	Result								
Type	Value								
Name	WIN-19GMU81KDKB								
Program Name	Windows 7 Professional Service Pack 1								
Processor Architecture	AMD64								
Temporary Files Directo	%SystemRoot%\TEMP								
Path	C:\Windows								
Product ID	00371-OEM-0635205-69564								
Owner	Windows User								
Source File Path	/img_T_123_Desktop.E01								
Artifact ID	-9223372036854775664								

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331.20950.0.21402.40.15.0.25.25.0.63.827.15.15.0....0...1ac.1.34.heirloom-serp.14.26.827.0vhr1WLRDoo

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Name	S	C	O	Modified Time	Change Time	Access Time	Created Time	Size	Flags(Dir)	Flags(Meta)	Known	Location
DSC00456.JPG				2015-08-31 20:09:30 UTC	2015-08-31 20:09:30 UTC	2015-08-31 20:06:11 UTC	2015-08-31 20:06:11 UTC	3653588	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_T_123_De
DSC00456.JPG				2015-08-31 20:09:30 UTC	2015-08-31 20:09:30 UTC	2015-08-31 20:06:20 UTC	2015-08-31 20:06:20 UTC	3532167	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_T_123_De



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First Degree Robbery, Second Degree Robbery, and Third Degree Robbery

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